

**Information Privacy & Security**  
**Assignment # 1**  
**MS(CS)**

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**Topic:** Protecting the Interests of Consumers in E-Commerce  
Transactions in Digital Transformation Era

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## **PROTECTING THE INTERESTS OF CONSUMERS IN E-COMMERCE** **TRANSACTIONS IN DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION ERA**

E-commerce is carrying out any financial activity over the internet. It is the buying and selling of good or services via the internet, and the transfer of money and data to complete the sales. It's also known as electronic commerce or internet commerce. Everyone wants to make payments fully safe and secure. For Global or over internet level communication there are many types of digital payments and threats as well. So there are different issues regarding the protection of consumer interests in digital transactions.

### **RELATED STUDIES:**

Vancauteren et al.(2011) states that consumer protection is one of the hot issue in e-commerce around the world. Although e-commerce increases the productivity and provides more choices in terms of cost savings and competitiveness. Chawla & Kumar (2021) describe findings are that a secure and reliable system is essential for e-business firms to work successfully; cash on delivery is the priority option for online shopping; website information and effective customer care services build a customer's trust. Besides factors such as security, privacy, warranty, customer service, and website information, laws governing consumer rights protection in e-commerce influence customers' trust.

Shaik & Poojasree (2021) state that undoubtedly the existence of several advantages of E-Commerce like easy access to virtual global market, reduction in distribution costs, time saving, building a healthier relationship with consumers etc, yet the legal and security risk is still a major threat in the digitalized market.

As we know that the payment information in any E Commerce site is very much confidential and the leakage or interception of such information is a disaster for the reputation of that particular web site. The data in such types of payments is very confidential from client's perspective e.g. credit card numbers & pins. To attain the efficiency and security in online payments, different techniques are used.

## **METHODOLOGY:**

In the study, Authors have mainly used experience, observations and qualitative analysis with combination and inductive methods. Dialectical materialism method has also been used.

In order to protect the interests of consumers, in addition to recognizing the rights of consumers as well as the responsibilities of production and business organizations and individuals, the administrative, civil and criminal laws also stipulate the sanctions for acts of infringing on consumers' interests in e-commerce to ensure that consumers' rights are implemented in practice. Currently, when the revolution of science and information technology is developing more and more, the issue of protecting consumers' interests is increasingly concerned.

When entering into an e-commerce contract, the seller and the buyer do not know each other, because the electronic environment is an open environment, multi-directional communication and connection through many intermediaries, so there is no basis of trust; features of e-commerce websites are limited, information security is low. Consumers have not yet formed the habit of online shopping and are still worried that transactions will be taken advantage of by unfair commercial practices, unsecured payment methods, loss or disclosure of personal information

Although e-commerce transactions in our country tend to increase, the number of people actually participating in transactions and buying and selling goods online compared to the number of Internet users only accounts for about 3-4%. Only in Vietnam Valuation Joint Stock Company (one of the top 10 enterprises with the leading e-commerce website today - vatgia.com) was established in 2007, but the growth rate is 7%/month both in volume and volume. transactions and the number of participating members. It is estimated that the value of e-commerce transactions in Vietnam will reach about 2-4% of total domestic consumption. In our country, the number of people performing electronic transactions is increasing with a total transaction value of about 300-400 million USD/year.

In fact, many frauds in e-commerce occurred, in which the buyer transferred money to the seller but did not receive the goods due to fraud by the seller; issues of confidentiality, safety of personal information, ambiguous contracts on prices, false advertising, poor quality of goods, violation of consumer rights... are existing problems. Last but not least, In the electronic environment, personal information has become a valuable commodity for illegal businesses

to illegally exploit and use this information for personal gain. According to experts of the Competition Administration Department,

Vietnamese consumers' awareness of information technology as well as about e-commerce is still limited, so their rights are still limited. It was only in the early 21st decade, especially in recent years with the explosion of the Internet, that e-transactions in our country could not be opened in development steps.

Thus, for organizations and individuals trading in goods and services on the List of essential goods and services promulgated by the Prime Minister, they have to perform the obligation to register a commercial contract and register with the agency. In fact, the control of commercial transactions and registration is not classified according to the entity performing the registration obligation as an enterprise, but by the type/group of goods and services that the enterprise is trading.